Public GitHub repo: https://github.com/niwo-pdx/niwo-pdx.github.io
Deployed site: https://niwo-pdx.github.io/

2/20/26

- Made GitHub repo, niwo-pdx.github.io
    - Set to private initially after researching to verify that commits will be made public when visibility is changed later
- Made initial commit of empty files (index.html, index.js, styles.css, README.md) to confirm repo functionality
- Started the HTML document
    - Began with default skeleton, added link to (currently empty) CSS and JavaScript files, found a favicon off of fontawesome and added that as well
        - Made an images folder for the favicon
    - Started to flesh out HTML to include a navigation bar, put filler text in the body
- Started the CSS document
    - Referenced the media queries exercise from earlier in the term to play with how to style the nav bar, though I think I'll likely change it later
    - Experimented with color schemes
        - (Don't worry, I'm a visual artist with design experience)
        - (I will still probably change all of this later, but it's a start)
        - (Side note, I did have a laugh at how many times you mentioned to stick to one or two colors in that lecture. Trying to protect your poor students from their own lack of design sense)
- Made first substantial commit with above additions

2/21/26

- Spent some time working on the content of the website
- Thinking about the layout - I would like to do separate pages, though I recognize I currently don't have a lot to share about myself professionally (at least in terms of CS) so I'm considering how this might affect the layout
- No GitHub commits

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<!-- despite being convinced I could work on this while traveling, I was waylaid by a sudden trip to help out family … so, I return, no progress made … -->

3/9/26

- I wanted to take today to set up the skeleton for the rest of my website. I don't think I have enough content to really flesh out each page, but I know that'll change in the future, and I wanted to experiment with having multiple pages.
- I didn't like the idea of copy-pasting my navbar (and then saw later that you mentioned the need for a workaround in that regard), so I looked up what people suggested:
    - Ultimately came across this solution on stackoverflow - not my favorite site to reference, but the concept seems straightforward. I'll probably revisit this later to see if there's a better way. You basically just set up a div for a navbar placeholder, and then have a JS function to load a nav.html file.
- New files include: nav.html, about.html, experience.html, projects.html, contact.html, images/me.jpg
    - nav.html just includes the html for the nav bar, nothing else (updated with the appropriate links now)
    - The remainder are essentially empty, though I put a photo of me and my cat in the About page
- Git commit made with above additions/changes

3/10/26

- Mostly worked on getting the navigation bar to be responsive such that it was fixed on the left for full sized screens, and then at the top for tablet and mobile sized screens
    - I'm having an annoying issue with the horizontal navbars having a little strip of space instead of aligning fully to the top and across the screen. I'll have to fix this later, I know it's something with the padding or margins
- Messed with some styling in general

- Added GitHub and LinkedIn pngs to incorporate later, will resize and edit before I do that though
- No huge updates, pushed to Git to be safe though

3/12/26

- Built out a very basic form via HTML, in the process of researching where and how I should send whatever information is included (in this case: name, email, & message)
    - Sending directly to a specified email address isn't possible just through HTML/JavaScript; requires something like an endpoint, or PHP (or Flask?)
    - Some general information on sending forms here
    - I am actually a fair bit concerned about the security of letting users just send email through a third party service
        - Probably good to look at data validation with JS to start
- Did some research on what's out there for making something like a timeline to visualize work history and came across this

3/13/26

- Considering just using mailto for my form for now, though I don't like the functionality of it it would be nice to have something that works at all for the time being
- Spent some time messing with CSS grids to reformat my about page, deciding I need to really condense this to a single page rather than multiple because I just don't have enough content - especially when viewing on a desktop browser
    - Taking some time to reconceptualize this before I get back to coding by drawing out some mockups
- Found a fun article about styling web forms like a postcard

3/15/26

- Finally condensed my site back into one page rather than multiple, decided to keep the navigation HTML separate with the JavaScript to insert it in so that I can expand the website more easily later if I desire
- Did some small formatting changes, inserting styled horizontal lines under the headings and attempting a box around the title of the page. I thought I might add some details here but I don't know if I like how it looks visually, so I might change that as well
    - There's a lot of blank space that I feel like I have to address - I don't want things to be overly cluttered visually, but some small illustrations might be nice

3/16/26

- Worked on some styling, trying to get the spacing to make sense (especially for desktop browsers)
- Added LinkedIn and GitHub icon links to the about section
- Added a carousel at the bottom next to the contact form at desktop size for fun (cycles through photos I've taken on hikes locally)
    - Some weird bugs with the arrows that I'll try and address later, though I'm not sure if I'll keep the carousel permanently

3/17/26

- Worked on formatting
    - Formatted form, tweaked some sections, added a footer
- Filled out sections with more information
- Set up mailto so that the form has functionality
- Wrote up markdown document notating sources and how to deploy locally

Future Goals

- Bilingual (en/jp) site implemented with JavaScript, using this open source project (article here)
- Add some graphic design details
    - Snake plant in bottom left over navbar on desktop, adansonii monstera cascading from top right?
    - Improved header
        - Possible eventual logo design even though I hate designing logos
- Probably remove or rethink the carousel, I'm not actually a huge fan of them but it's nice to give a little personality to the site somehow (static photo is probably fine)
- Implementation of (interactive?) timeline for past work section